

Karthik Raghavan

Senior Backend Engineer — Payments

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SUMMARY

Backend engineer with 8 years building payment systems on the JVM, currently on a UPI switch stack clearing 14M transactions/day. Led ISO 8583 to ISO 20022 transformation work and three NPCI compliance release cycles. Deep with Kafka, Spring Boot and Kubernetes on AWS; strong believer in you-build-it-you-run-it. Notice period: 30 days.

SKILLS

Languages: Java 21, Kotlin, SQL, Bash

Frameworks: Spring Boot 3, Spring Cloud Stream, JUnit 5, Testcontainers

Platform: Kafka, PostgreSQL, Oracle, Kubernetes (EKS), AWS, Terraform, GitHub Actions

Domain: UPI (switch + TPAP integrations), IMPS/NEFT, ISO 8583, ISO 20022 (pacs/camt), NPCI certification cycles, idempotency & outbox patterns

EXPERIENCE

Senior Backend Engineer — Aurus Pay Technologies, Bengaluru

Mar 2021 – present

- Tech lead for the UPI switch-services team (6 engineers) on a platform processing 14M transactions/day at 99.99% availability, including Diwali and IPL-final peaks at 3x average load.
- Led the ISO 20022 message-transformation track for NEFT/RTGS connectivity; delivered pacs.008/pacs.002 services ahead of the RBI cutover window.
- Cut duplicate-debit incidents to zero by introducing an idempotency-key store and transactional outbox across 12 services.
- Reduced p99 end-to-end UPI leg latency from 890ms to 310ms by re-partitioning Kafka topics and removing synchronous fan-out.

Backend Engineer — Meru Financial Systems, Chennai

Sep 2018 – Feb 2021

- Built IMPS and NEFT processing modules (Java/Spring Boot) deployed at four bank clients.
- Introduced Testcontainers-based integration tests, moving the team from monthly to fortnightly releases.
- On-call for production; wrote the team's first structured runbooks.

Systems Engineer — Infosys, Mysuru / Chennai

Jul 2017 – Aug 2018

- Java development for a BFSI client; REST APIs and batch processing.

EDUCATION

B.Tech Computer Science & Engineering — NIT Tiruchirappalli, 2013 – 2017

CERTIFICATIONS

- AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate (2023)
- Confluent Certified Developer for Apache Kafka (2022)

LANGUAGES KNOWN

Tamil (native), English (fluent), Hindi (working), Kannada (basic)